

Priya, 24, software engineer, Bengaluru

Salaried.

Gross salary	₹12,00,000
Basic	₹6,00,000
HRA received	₹3,00,000
Rent	₹25,000/month, ₹3,00,000/year
City	non-metro, so 40% of basic
80C already claimed	₹50,000
Bank	HDFC, ₹2,40,000
Transactions	90
Goals	Emergency fund, Vacation

What she exercises: Form 16, employer TDS, regime comparison, HRA least-of-three, section 87A.

Why she is the most valuable fixture. Her new-regime tax is **exactly ₹0**, and that single number tests three rules at once: the ₹75,000 standard deduction, the slab table, and the 87A rebate. Break any one and the answer stops being zero. It is one assertion guarding three subsystems.

Her HRA is the other reason. The exemption is the least of ₹3,00,000 received, ₹2,40,000 being 40% of basic, and ₹2,40,000 being rent minus 10% of basic. The 40% rule wins because Bengaluru is not a metro. If someone wrongly treats Bengaluru as a metro, her number changes and a test fails.

Arjun, 28, business owner, Mumbai

Runs a digital services business.

Gross income	₹15,00,000
Business turnover	₹24,00,000
Business expenses	₹9,00,000
Digital receipts	95%, so 44AD applies at the lower rate
Rent	₹40,000/month
City	Mumbai, metro
Deductions	80C ₹1,00,000, 80D ₹25,000
Banks	ICICI personal ₹4,50,000, ICICI current ₹6,20,000
Transactions	210

What he exercises: GST registration and input credit, advance tax, presumptive taxation under 44AD, profit and loss.

Why his numbers are set this way. Because 95% of his receipts are digital, section 44AD applies at 6% rather than 8%, so his deemed profit is ₹1,44,000 against ₹15,00,000 by real books. That gap is enormous, which is exactly the point: it shows why service businesses with high margins use presumptive taxation, and it lets the app also state the conditions attached.

His turnover of ₹24,00,000 is deliberately **above** the ₹20,00,000 GST threshold, so his registration flag is genuinely true.

Rohan, 26, freelance designer, Pune

Self-employed professional.

Gross income	₹14,00,000
Gross receipts	₹18,00,000
Export receipts	₹10,00,000, zero-rated
Domestic receipts	₹8,00,000
Business expenses	₹4,00,000
194J TDS deducted	₹80,000
Rent	₹18,000/month
City	Pune, non-metro
80C	₹60,000
Banks	Axis personal ₹1,80,000, Axis current ₹3,20,000
Transactions	210

What he exercises: section 194J TDS deducted by clients, GST threshold proximity, presumptive taxation under 44ADA.

Why the numbers are set this way. His domestic receipts are ₹8,00,000, which is **₹2,00,000 short** of the ₹20,00,000 threshold. Not comfortably below, not over. That forces the registration flag to be genuinely computed rather than trivially true or false.

The 194J figure is deliberately wrong on purpose. Clients should have deducted ₹1,80,000 at 10%, and only ₹80,000 was actually deducted. The app surfaces the ₹1,00,000 shortfall, which is a real thing that happens to real freelancers.